

Unilever Autonomous Sourcing

Infosys × Aerchain — agent-run sourcing, live and delivering value

The shift

From classical, manual sourcing to autonomous, agent-run sourcing — deployed by Infosys at Unilever.

BEFORE

Unilever before Infosys-Aerchain

✗

Classical, manual sourcing

✗

Heavy Excel dependency

✗

Time & resource constraints

✗

Gaps in category expertise

✗

Limited negotiation leverage

✗

Reliance on past data & benchmarks

NOW • WITH INFOSYS-AERCHAIN

Autonomous, agent-run sourcing

✓

AI-driven, time-saving sourcing

✓

Automated quotes, RFx & questionnaires

✓

Intelligent supplier ranking

✓

Automated communication with live tracking

✓

AI-powered insights & query support

✓

Improved negotiation & faster value realization

Outcome today

Already in production — and already delivering hard, banked savings.

\$5M

Savings unlocked

on a \$54M spend across 37 sourcing projects
— 10% average yield

Live

In production

today for Unilever Business Services

Scaling

Marketing & IT

Infosys-managed spend, and beyond

The impact

A return that is underwritten by results, not projections.

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Return on investment

on \$15.5M committed savings in 2026

\$265K

Annual platform cost

fully-loaded run cost for 2026

\$8M

Hard savings in 2025

delivered, banked, audited

~3%

FTE efficiency gain

year on year, plus negotiation uplift

How Aerchain works

Five agents run the sourcing cycle autonomously, with human-in-the-loop guardrails per category — all live in production.

AGENT 01

Intake

Auto-ingests & enriches every request; cleans maverick descriptions and classifies spend.

✓ LIVE • UNILEVER

AGENT 02

Sourcing

Builds the RFQ, runs outreach, follow-up and bid extraction across your supplier base.

✓ LIVE • UNILEVER

AGENT 03

Negotiation

Multi-round, multi-parameter autonomous negotiation across price, terms & lead time.

✓ LIVE • UNILEVER

AGENT 04

Evaluation

Scores every bid and runs compliance & risk checks silently in the background.

✓ LIVE • UNILEVER

AGENT 05

Award

Generates award scenarios, recommends allocation and writes the PO back to the ERP.

✓ LIVE • UNILEVER

Value realization

Savings are accelerating — 2025 delivered, 2026 committed.

\$8M

2025 delivered

\$15.5M

2026 committed

\$54M

Addressable spend across 37 active sourcing projects

10%

Average savings yield realised per project

≈2×

Growth in committed savings, 2025 → 2026

1 : 58

Return on every dollar invested in the platform

Rollout roadmap

A staged path from live deployment to enterprise-wide autonomous sourcing.

NOW

Business Services

Live in production

→

NEXT

Marketing & IT

Infosys-managed spend

→

THEN

Enterprise-wide

Scaling beyond

Value delivery

Where the autonomous engine moves the needle

80%

Requests auto-routed by the orchestrator

95%

Policy compliance on every transaction

10%

Average hard-cash savings yield

+3%

Incremental negotiation efficiency

Frequently asked questions

✓

Does it integrate with our existing ERP and procurement tools?

Yes — Aerchain sits above SAP / Ariba and Coupa and keeps the ERP as the system of record.

✓

Is it secure and compliant (SOC 2, GDPR)?

Yes. Compliance, SoD and risk checks run as a built-in subroutine on every transaction.

✓

Do users stay in control with AI in the loop?

Always. Human-in-the-loop guardrails are configurable per category and toggle-controlled.

✓

Can it scale beyond Business Services?

Yes — the same engine extends to Marketing, IT and Infosys-managed spend enterprise-wide.

✓

How fast do we see value?

Business Services is already live; \$8M was delivered in 2025 with \$15.5M committed for 2026.

✓

Does it replace our category teams?

No. It removes the manual load so category experts focus on strategy and supplier value.